
Chapter Seven

Team Management

Introduction

- A **team** is a number of persons associated together in work or activity: as a group on one side (as in football or debate).”
- **Teamwork** - is close cooperation between cross-trained employees who are familiar with a wide range of jobs in their organization.
- **Team-building** - is high interaction among group members to increase trust and openness.
- **Team management** refers to techniques, processes and tools for organizing and coordinating a group of individuals working towards a common goal—i.e. a team.

Team Vs Groups

- **Team –**

- » A small number of members with shared leadership who perform interdependent jobs with both individual and group accountability, evaluation, and rewards.
- » Is a group of people who come together temporarily to achieve a purpose.
- » Member's collective performance determines results.

- **Group –**

- » Two or more members with a clear leader who perform independent jobs with individual accountability, evaluation, and rewards.
- » A collection of people who interact with one another, accept rights and obligations as members and who share a common identity.
- » Members responsible for their own contributions.

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	Group	Team
Understandings	Members think they are grouped together for administrative purposes only.	Members recognize their independence and understand both personal and team goals are best accomplished with mutual support.
Ownership	Members tend to focus on themselves because they are not sufficiently involved in planning the unit's objectives.	Members feel a sense of ownership for their jobs and unit, because they are committed to value based common goals that they helped establish.
Creativity and Contribution	Members are told what to do rather than being asked what the best approach would be.	Members contribute to the organization's success by applying their unique talents, knowledge and creativity to team objectives.
Clear Leadership	Members tend to work in an unstructured environment with undetermined standards of performance. Leaders do not walk the talk and tend to lead from behind a desk.	Members work in a structured environment, they know what boundaries exist and who has final authority. The leader sets agreed high standards of performance and he/she is respected via active, willing participation.

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	Group	Team
Trust	Members distrust the motives of colleagues because they do not understand the role of other members.	Members work in a climate of trust and are encouraged to openly express ideas, opinions, disagreements and feelings. Questions are welcomed
Conflict Resolution	Members find themselves in conflict situations they do not know how to resolve. Their supervisor/leader may put off intervention until serious damage is done, i.e. a crisis situation	Members realize conflict is a normal aspect of human interaction but they view such situations as an opportunity for new ideas and creativity. They work to resolve conflict quickly and constructively.
Participative Decision Making	Members may or may not participate in decisions affecting the team. Conformity often appears more important than positive results. Win/lose situations are common.	Members participate in decisions affecting the team but understand their leader must make a final ruling whenever the team cannot decide, or an emergency exists. Positive win/win results are the goal at all times.

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	Group	Team
Personal Development	Members receive good training but are limited in applying it to the job by the manager or other group members.	Members are encouraged to continually develop skills and apply what they learn on the job. They perceive they have the support of the team.
Commitment	Members are uncommitted towards excellence and personal pride. Performance levels tend to be mediocre. Staff turnover is high because talented individuals quickly recognize that (a) personal expectations are not being fulfilled (b) they are not learning and growing from others and (c) they are not working with the best people	Only those committed to excellence are hired. Prospective team members are queuing at the door to be recruited on the basis of their high levels of hard and soft skill sets. Everyone works together in a harmonious environment.

Why Teams Fail?

- **No Vision**

- » If a team does not have a vision the possibilities for failure are great.
- » The entire team must produce the casting of a vision.
- » There will always be those who lead the way however, all members of the team must be included in the vision casting process.

- **Failure to Be Personally Responsible**

- » Teams can never hope to succeed if one person on the team refuses to play their part.
- » The success of any team is dependent upon the involvement of every person on the team.
- » The skills of the many are what make a great and productive team.

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- **Conflict Between Personalities**

- » One of the great challenges of teams and teamwork is to recognize that we are all different but these differences can produce great power when combined together.
- » Conflicts will take place but if handled in the proper fashion these very conflicts can produce a strong team of complimentary personalities.

- **Power Struggles**

- » One of the greatest challenges for any team is to work on bringing out the talents and gifts of the entire team.
- » The failure of most teams is the result of one or two people leading the way and leaving very gifted people behind.
- » Those left behind may not say any thing about this action but they will soon become inactive and the team is reduced to the one or two strong personalities.

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- **No Clear Identity**

- » A strong team will also know the “play book.”
- » The direction, focus, and goals must be stated.
- » It is best to write these things down and for every team member to be able to identify their purpose and direction in less than a paragraph. Two sentences would be best.
- » A team without a clear identity will never succeed.

- **No Coaching**

- » A coach will give the team an edge for strong development.
- » The insights and “wisdom” of someone that is not on the team can give the team the benefit of hearing from an observer.
- » This calls for the team to put egos aside and embrace a willingness to receive productive criticism.

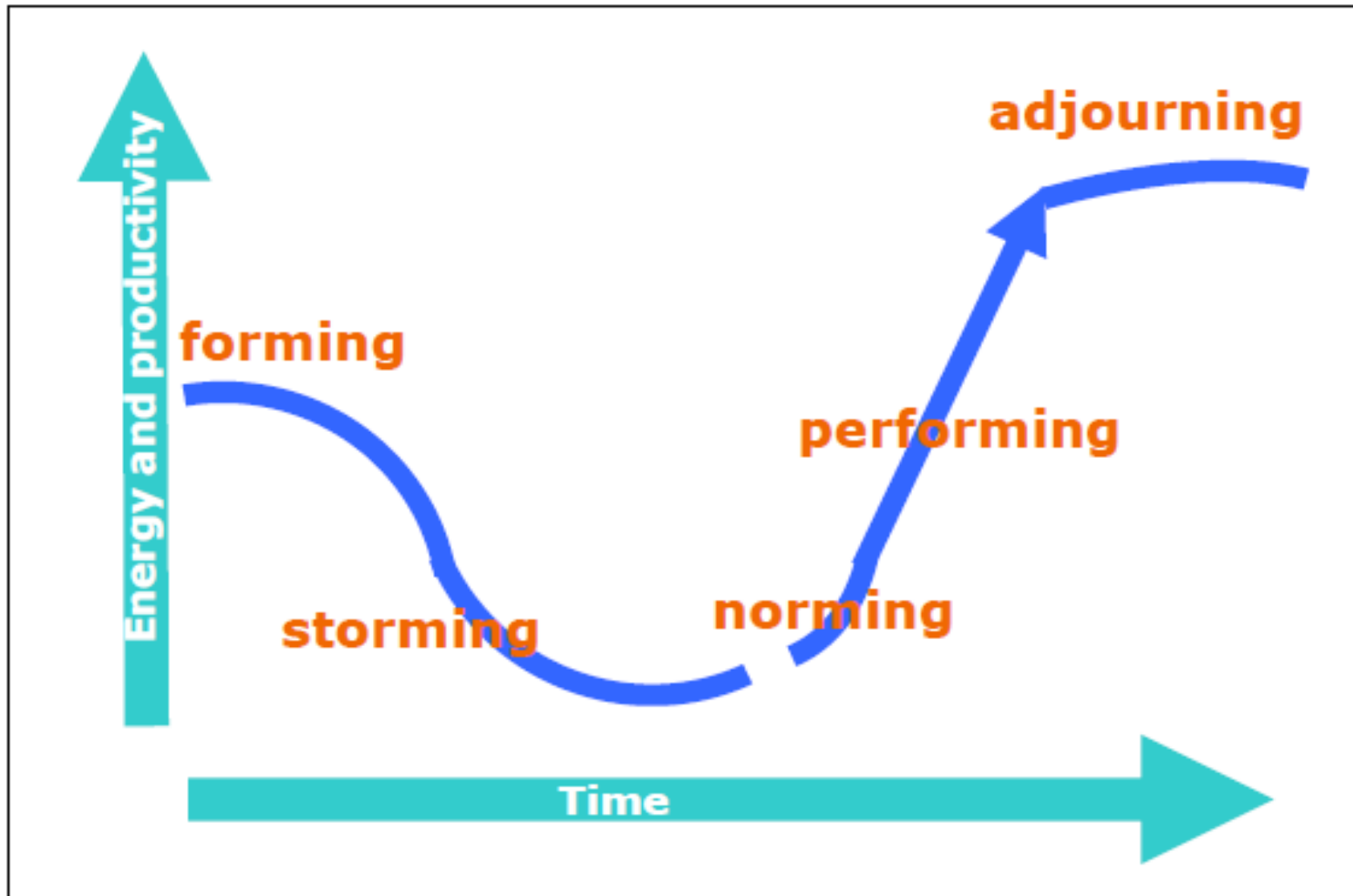
Team Building

- Team Building
 - » Process of establishing and developing a greater sense of collaboration and trust between members.
- Why Should We Be a Team?
 - » When staff use their skills and knowledge together, the result is a stronger agency that can fulfill its mission.
 - » People working together can sustain the enthusiasm and lend support needed to complete the work of each program.
- How does a Team Work Best? A Teams succeeds when its members have:
 - » a commitment to common objectives
 - » defined roles and responsibilities
 - » effective decision systems, communication and work procedures
 - » good personal relationships

Stages in Team Building (Team Dev't Model)

- It takes time for people in a new team to learn how to work together effectively.
- Teams often go through recognizable stages as they change from being collections of strangers to becoming united groups with common goals.
- The ***Forming, Storming, Norming, and Performing*** model describes these stages.
- Psychologist ***Bruce Tuckman*** first came up with the memorable phrase, “forming, storming, norming, and performing” in 1965.
- Later, he added a fifth stage, “***adjourning***” (which is also sometimes known as “mourning”).

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Forming

- Each member of the team focuses on the leader, accepting only the leader's guidance and authority and maintaining a polite but distant relationship with the others.
- During this stage the leader must be seen to be open with information and ready to answer the many questions that will come her or his way; boundaries, strengths and weaknesses will be tested, including those of the leader.
- There is likely to be some baggage regarding the way people have been treated in the past, which might result in some clinging to the old ways, if their experience was positive, or suspicion and apathy if it left scars.
- *Expectations and job descriptions should be clearly laid out and the leader should role model the behavior he or she would like to see the team exhibit.*

Storming

- This is a difficult time for all.
- Team members are more concerned with the impression they are making than the project in hand; wanting to be respected, battling with feelings of inadequacy, wondering who will support or undermine them, and above all proving to the leader their value to the team.
- This is the time when curt e-mails written in the heat of the moment should be left to cool overnight in the Drafts box before being reviewed and moderated in the morning.
- There is a danger of factions forming and some members becoming isolated, particularly in today's era of virtual teams in far flung places.

Norming

- If the team can reach the Norming stage they are probably home and dry.
- If the Norming stage can be reached, it is an exciting time for all, when big decisions can be made and implemented, new ideas turned into reality, risks taken and failure seen as simply another step along the pathway to success.
- Roles and relationships are now established, freeing people up to concentrate on exercising the talents that got them into the team in the first place.
- *Leaders should use a coaching style and ask the team for their solutions before giving the leader's own.*
- *A team at the Norming stage will have much to offer in terms of experience and ideas which, if accessed, can save leaders time and energy, leaving them free to focus on the wider horizon.*

Performing

- The team is now a powerful engine running with all its cogs turning.
- Plenty of healthy conflict, of the type that does not damage the fabric of the relationships, is interspersed with fun and humor.
- Successes almost seem to create themselves; the leader and team members have learned to give their very best then get out of the way.
- *The leader and team members should recognize the contributions of others and ensure that credit is awarded where due.*

Adjourning

- The 'adjourning' stage is about bringing a sense of closure to a team whose project is completed.
- If the team successfully negotiated the first four stages, there may be some bonding between members and a sense of loss at disbanding those relationships.
- People will also be looking back to the beginning, noticing how far they have come and measuring what their contribution has been to the whole.
- *Adjourning is a time for thank-you's, recognition of individual achievements and reflection on how far the team has come, the turning points along the way, and what its members can take forward from the team to the future.*

Types of Team

- Teams can be classified according to their objective.
- The Four most common forms of teams are:
 - » Problem solving team
 - » Self-managed team
 - » Cross-functional team and
 - » Virtual team

Problem-Solving Team

- Typically composed of 5 to 12 employees from the same department who meet for a few hours each week to discuss ways of improving quality, efficiency and the work environment.
- Organizations are relaying more and more on problem-solving team to help solve organizational problems.
- Members share ideas or offer suggestions on how work process and methods can be improved.

Self-managed Team

- Composed of 10 to 15 people who take on the responsibilities of their former supervisors.
- Fully self-managed teams select their own members and the members evaluate each other's performance.
- Supervisory positions take on decreased importance and may even be eliminated.

Cross-Functional Team

- Made of employees at about the same hierarchical level, but from different work areas, who come together to accomplish a task.
- It is an effective means of allowing people from diverse areas within an organization to exchange information, develop new ideas, solve problems and coordinate complex projects.
- It brings people with different functional specialties to better invent, design or deliver a product or service.
- The goal of using this team is a combination of innovation, speed and quality that come from early coordination among various specialties.

Virtual Team

- Use computer technology to tie tighter physically dispersed members in order to achieve a common goal.
- They allow people to collaborate online, whether they are only a room apart or separated by continents.
- The three primary factors that differentiate virtual team from face to face team are;
 - » The absence of Para verbal and nonverbal cues.
 - » Limited social context.
 - » The ability to overcome time and space constraints.

Team Dynamics

- Team dynamics refers to the relationship between a group of dedicated employees working together to increase the output and value of a corporation.
- In the workplace, teamwork is most effective when the goal is clear to all employees.
- This goal should also be compatible with the company's vision.
- The goals of the team should be clearly spelled out in a way that everyone can understand, and there should be some consistency with company policy.

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- Before any real teamwork can occur, the employees making up this team must understand each other.
- When employees understand each other, they can respect each other, and this creates an environment where they can begin to trust each other.
- The best way to begin building this trust is to persuade each employee to contribute their strengths and talents, while at the same time encouraging all of them to support each other to eliminate or compensate for weaknesses in the team.
- This also has the effect of bringing out the best in each individual employee.

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- To have a strong team, then consider creating a team that has at least some diversity. A variety of ages, cultures, and educational backgrounds will mean that everyone has something unique to contribute, and you won't be hearing the same suggestion multiple times.
- Even more than that, a diverse group working together will generate results at a faster pace than a group that is full of carbon copies.
- They will be able to brainstorm in such a way that no two people will be offering exactly the same ideas.
- A diverse group will be able to come together and work towards the collective mission of the organization with greater speed and efficiency.

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- Each member of the team contributes by performing to the best of their ability, and they tend to, at least generally, perform better within a group than they will individually.
- These employees, feeling as if they are truly a member of a team, become recommitted to the goals of the corporation, and can overcome obstacles with greater ease and speed than they could working on their own.
- The sense of teamwork increases the self-esteem of everyone involved, and this generally results in higher customer satisfaction.

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- Positive team dynamics generate a sense of pride among employees.
- It increases the effectiveness of each employee by creating good work habits and facilitating creativity.
- Employees engaged in a team will be more likely to put the needs of the company first, and will be more willing to assist in the accomplishment of the company's goals.

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- Team and group dynamics are influenced by many factors, such as
 - » The larger context in which the team operates,
 - » The organization,
 - » The team identity itself, and
 - » The mix of individuals within the team.

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- **The Context of the Team**

- » The country and geographic region form a larger culture in which the organization operates.
- » All of these contribute to the economic, political, technical, and cultural climates in which the organization, the team, and the individuals operate.

- **The Organization**

- » The kind of organization, such as business, or non-profit, along with the organizational culture will influence the team functioning just as much as the division of the organization such as sales, research, operations, etc.

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- **The Team Identity**

- » Teams have an identity of their own. This identity stems from the interrelationship of the larger culture, the organizational culture, the team configuration, the nature of the work (purpose), and the qualities of the individuals.
- » It is not the sum of the types, or preferences, or temperaments of the team members.

- **The Individuals**

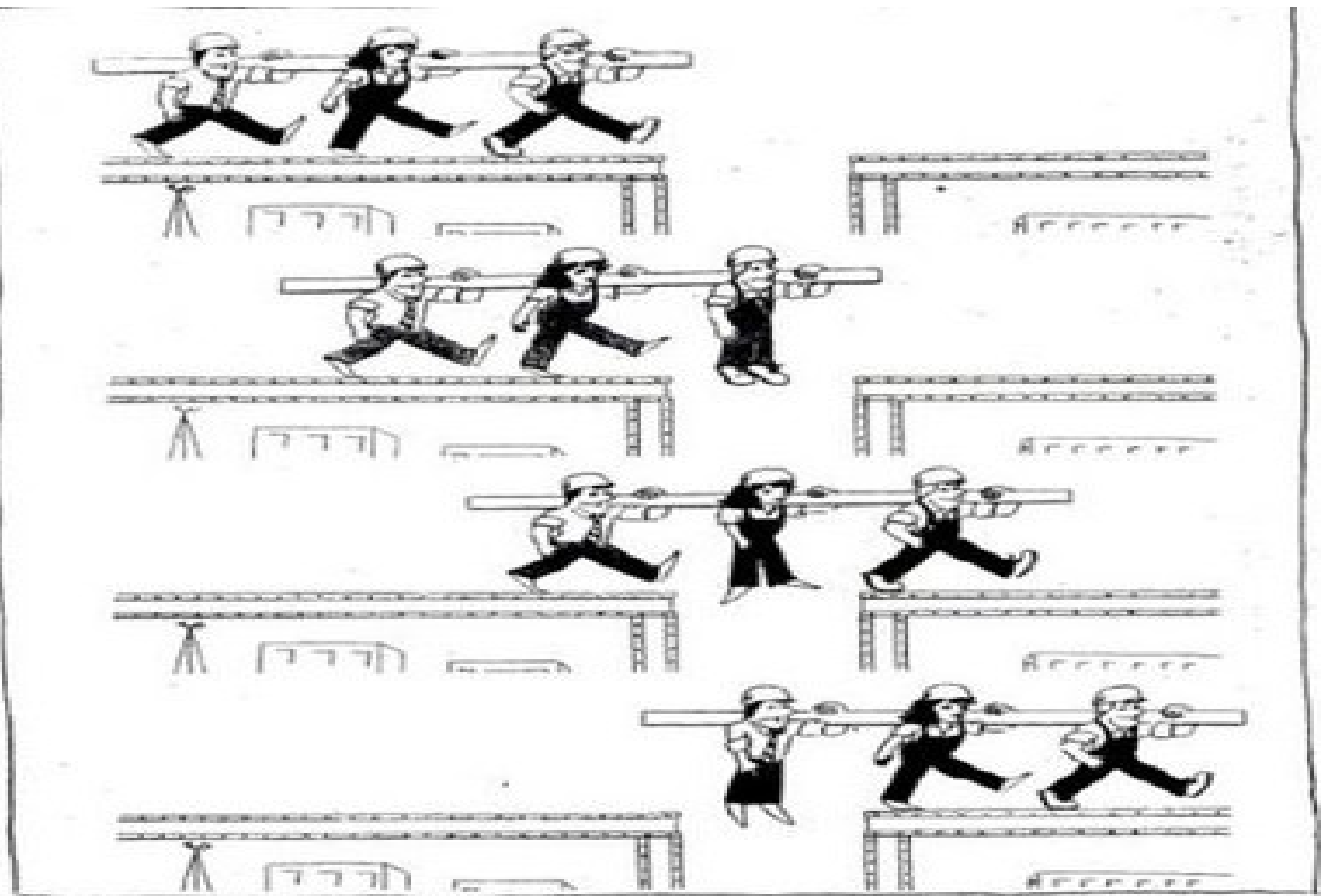
- » Within this mix of influences are the individual team members who likely have specific kinds of work to perform and specific roles on the team.
- » Individual members influence the team dynamics as well, so much so that when the composition of the team changes, the team dynamics will change.

Team Success Criteria

- **Clear team goals, measurements, and expected results**
(Includes purpose) –
 - » Helps the team see their role in the success of the team. The team goals and expectations should be understood by everyone
- **Team Norms** –
 - » Ground rules that govern a group - Common Understanding of what is and what is not acceptable behavior for all team members.
- **Individual & Shared Team Member Roles/Responsibilities** –
 - » Team members are aware of their contribution to the team and their individual and shared expectations

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- **Operating procedures/processes –**
 - » Standard operating procedures/processes (internal communication, decision making, conflict resolution, etc).
- **Clear & Open Communication –**
 - » Communication that is clear and honest; team members share information (Both Types of Communication: Advocacy and Inquiry)



Every member in a Team, has times when they need support -- > > >